

D725

Early Clinical in Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A fifth grader with a learning disability in reading takes the same science test as classmates, but the teacher reads the questions aloud. The student also uses a blue pencil grip and loves robotics. What kind of support is the read-aloud?

- A. An accommodation, because the student is held to the same content.
- B. An assistive device, like the pencil grip.
- C. A modification, because any IEP support lowers the standard.
- D. A modification, because the test is given differently.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

On a spelling test, a student with an intellectual disability is given 5 of the class's 20 words, chosen as functional words. What kind of change is this?

- A. Extended time.
- B. An accommodation, because it is written in the IEP.
- C. An accommodation, because the student still takes a test.
- D. A modification, because what the student must learn is changed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A team is deciding where a third grader with ADHD will receive math. The student's older brother went to the same school, and the student lives near the bus depot. No supports have yet been tried in the general classroom. What does the least restrictive environment principle require the team to consider first?

- A. A full-day special class, since ADHD affects math.
- B. Whether the student can succeed in general education with supplementary aids and services.
- C. General education with no supports, since LRE means inclusion always.
- D. The placement used for the older brother.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A clinical candidate writing a reflection paper for her university course wants to describe a student's behavior plan. The school has a garden club and a new principal. What should she do with the student information?

- A. Remove the name and any details that could identify the student, such as unusual traits or the exact class.
- B. Include everything, since the paper is for a class.
- C. Use the student's first name only.
- D. Ask the new principal to approve sharing the full record.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A candidate records that during a math worksheet in a warm, sunny room, the teacher said, "Start problem one," and then a fourth grader pushed the worksheet off the desk. The teacher then sent him to the hallway. The class had just come from music. In ABC data, what is the antecedent?

- A. The warm room and coming from music.
- B. Pushing the worksheet off the desk.
- C. The teacher's direction, "Start problem one."
- D. Being sent to the hallway.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

In several ABC records, a second grader tears her reading page each time independent reading starts, and each time she is sent to the calm corner and skips the reading. She has two younger sisters and rides the early bus. What is the most likely function of the behavior?

- A. Getting adult attention.
- B. Sensory, because tearing paper feels good.
- C. Wanting to go home early like her bus schedule.
- D. Escape from the reading task.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A behavior is known to be maintained by escape from hard tasks. Which plan works against that function?

- A.** Ignore it, because ignoring works for all behaviors.
- B.** Send the student to the hallway each time.
- C.** Teach the student to ask for a short break and keep returning the student to the task.
- D.** Give the student extra adult attention each time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

In a fourth-grade class, the general and special education teachers split the class in half; each teaches the same lesson on area to half the students at the same time. The room has two whiteboards, and one teacher just finished a master's degree. Which co-teaching model is this?

- A.** One teach, one observe.
- B.** Team teaching.
- C.** Parallel teaching.
- D.** Station teaching.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A co-teacher wants to pull a small group for five days to preteach vocabulary while the other teacher leads the large group. Which model fits?

- A.** Parallel teaching.
- B.** One teach, one assist.
- C.** Team teaching.
- D.** Alternative teaching.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A candidate drafting notes for a meeting with a family that recently moved from another district writes, "The Down syndrome girl can't do anything in math." The meeting is at 3:30 in the library. What revision best fits professional practice?

- A.** "The Down syndrome student is very low in math."
- B.** "The student, who has Down syndrome, counts to 20 with objects and is working on adding within 5."
- C.** Add the meeting time and place to the note.
- D.** Leave the diagnosis out of all notes forever.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A kindergartner walks away from the group during circle time. Staff are worried about how long he stays away, not how many times he leaves. The circle area has a new alphabet rug. Which measure should the candidate use?

- A.** Anecdotal notes only, since numbers are never needed in kindergarten.
- B.** Duration recording.
- C.** Latency recording.
- D.** Event (frequency) recording.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team wants to know how many seconds pass between the teacher saying "Take out your folder" and the student starting to do it. Across three tries the times were 40, 25, and 55 seconds. Which measure is this, and what is the average?

- A.** Latency; 40 seconds.
- B.** Duration; 40 seconds.
- C.** Latency; 120 seconds.
- D.** Latency; 55 seconds.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A fifth grader with a learning disability in reading takes the same science test as classmates, but the teacher reads the questions aloud. ~~The student also uses a blue pencil grip and loves robotics.~~ What kind of support is the read-aloud?

Target word: accommodation or modification **Decides:** The test content and expectations stay the same.

A	Correct	The change affects access (how), not what is measured.
B	Camouflage	Answers the pencil-grip detail; the read-aloud is a testing accommodation.
C	Absolute language	Accommodations by definition keep the standard.
D	Confusion set	A change in format is not a change in expectation.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

On a spelling test, a student with an intellectual disability is given 5 of the class's 20 words, chosen as functional words. What kind of change is this?

Target word: reverse: identify a modification **Decides:** The amount and content expected were reduced.

A	Wrong stem number	The number of words changed, not the time allowed.
B	Adjacent category	Both kinds appear in IEPs; being written there does not decide the type.
C	Inverted operation	Taking a test does not make it an accommodation when content is reduced.
D	Correct	Reducing and replacing content changes the expectation.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A team is deciding where a third grader with ADHD will receive math. ~~The student's older brother went to the same school, and the student lives near the bus depot.~~ No supports have yet been tried in the general classroom. What does the least restrictive environment principle require the team to consider first?

Target word: first placement consideration **Decides:** No supports have been tried in general education.

A	Inverted operation	Starts at the most restrictive option.
B	Correct	LRE requires trying supports in general education before removal.
C	Absolute language	LRE means maximum appropriate inclusion with supports, not inclusion without help.
D	Camouflage	Family history does not decide an individual placement.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A clinical candidate writing a reflection paper for her university course wants to describe a student's behavior plan. ~~The school has a garden club and a new principal.~~ What should she do with the student information?

Target word: handling student information outside the school **Decides:** The paper leaves the school team.

A	Correct	Confidentiality covers identifiable information, not just names.
B	Adjacent category	A university course is outside the student's need-to-know team.
C	Dropped element	A first name plus details can still identify the student.
D	Camouflage	Answers the principal detail; the need is de-identification, not approval to share.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A candidate records that during a math worksheet ~~in a warm, sunny room~~, the teacher said, "Start problem one," and then a fourth grader pushed the worksheet off the desk. The teacher then sent him to the hallway. ~~The class had just come from music.~~ In ABC data, what is the antecedent?

Target word: antecedent **Decides:** What happened right before the behavior.

A	Camouflage	Background details, not the event that triggered the behavior.
B	Confusion set	That is the behavior itself.
C	Correct	The antecedent is the event immediately before the behavior.
D	Inverted operation	That is the consequence, after the behavior.

6. Answer D Concept 5

In several ABC records, a second grader tears her reading page each time independent reading starts, and each time she is sent to the calm corner and skips the reading. ~~She has two younger sisters and rides the early bus.~~ What is the most likely function of the behavior?

Target word: function of the behavior **Decides:** The consequence each time is escape from reading.

A	Confusion set	The pattern shows removal from the task, not added attention.
B	Adjacent category	Possible in general, but the consistent pattern points to escape.
C	Camouflage	Answers the bus detail, which is irrelevant.
D	Correct	Each time the behavior ends with no reading, it is likely maintained by escape.

7. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A behavior is known to be maintained by escape from hard tasks. Which plan works against that function?

Target word: reverse: choose intervention for a known function **Decides:** Remove the payoff of escape and teach a better way to get a break.

A	Absolute language	Planned ignoring fits attention; it does not remove escape.
B	Inverted operation	Rewards the behavior with the escape it seeks.
C	Correct	Replacement behavior meets the need; the task still follows.
D	Confusion set	Treats an attention function, not escape.

8. Answer C Concept 6

In a fourth-grade class, the general and special education teachers split the class in half; each teaches the same lesson on area to half the students at the same time. ~~The room has two whiteboards, and one teacher just finished a master's degree.~~ Which co-teaching model is this?

Target word: name the model **Decides:** Same content, class split in two, simultaneous.

A	Inverted operation	Only one teacher instructs in that model.
B	Adjacent category	Team teachers share the whole class together.
C	Correct	Two teachers teach the same content to two halves at once.
D	Confusion set	In stations, groups rotate through different content.

9. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

A co-teacher wants to pull a small group for five days to preteach vocabulary while the other teacher leads the large group. Which model fits?

Target word: reverse: pick the model for the purpose **Decides:** Small group for a specific need while the large group continues.

A	Confusion set	Parallel splits the class into equal halves with the same lesson.
B	Dropped element	The assisting teacher circulates; no separate small group is taught.
C	Adjacent category	Team teaching keeps the whole group together.
D	Correct	One teacher takes a small group for targeted work while the other teaches the large group.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A candidate drafting notes for a meeting with a family ~~that recently moved from another district~~ writes, “The Down syndrome girl can’t do anything in math.” ~~The meeting is at 3:30 in the library.~~ What revision best fits professional practice?

Target word: professional wording **Decides:** Person-first, strengths-and-needs language.

A	Dropped element	Still leads with the label and lists only deficits.
B	Correct	Puts the person first and names both a strength and a need.
C	Camouflage	Answers the logistics detail, not the wording problem.
D	Absolute language	Disability information can be relevant; the issue is wording.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A kindergartner walks away from the group during circle time. Staff are worried about how long he stays away, not how many times he leaves. ~~The circle area has a new alphabet rug.~~ Which measure should the candidate use?

Target word: which data measure **Decides:** The concern is how long.

A	Absolute language	Measurable data are needed at any grade.
B	Correct	Duration captures how long each episode lasts.
C	Adjacent category	Latency is time from a direction to the start of a response.
D	Confusion set	Counts how often, which is not the concern.

12. Answer A Concept 8 • transfer

A team wants to know how many seconds pass between the teacher saying “Take out your folder” and the student starting to do it. Across three tries the times were 40, 25, and 55 seconds. Which measure is this, and what is the average?

Target word: reverse: name the measure and compute **Decides:** Time from direction to start; mean of three values.

A	Correct	$(40 + 25 + 55) / 3 = 120 / 3 = 40$ seconds.
B	Confusion set	Duration is how long a behavior lasts, not time before it starts.
C	Dropped element	The total, not divided by three tries.
D	Wrong stem number	The longest single time, not the average.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Accommodations vs. modifications	An accommodation changes how a student learns or shows learning without changing what is expected; a modification changes what the student is expected to learn.	Calling any change in an IEP an accommodation.	Is the standard or content the same or reduced?
2	Least restrictive environment	Students with disabilities are educated with nondisabled peers to the maximum extent appropriate; removal happens only when supports in general education are not enough.	Thinking LRE means every student must be in general education all day.	A placement decision that skips trying supports in the general classroom.
3	Confidentiality in field placements	Observers keep student information need-to-know: no names or identifying details in notes, assignments, or conversations outside the team.	Believing it is fine to share details if the student's name is left off but the student is still identifiable.	A candidate plans to write, post, or discuss student information outside the school.
4	ABC data collection	Record the antecedent (what came right before), the behavior (observable action), and the consequence (what happened right after).	Recording the setting or a guess about motive as the antecedent.	A behavior log with columns for before, during, and after.
5	Function of behavior	Behavior serves a function — commonly escape/avoidance, attention, access to something tangible, or sensory — and the intervention must match the function.	Choosing a consequence by the form of the behavior (e.g., time-out for all yelling) without asking what it gets the student.	The same outcome follows the behavior each time.
6	Co-teaching models	One teach/one observe, station, parallel, alternative, and team teaching differ in how the two teachers split students and roles.	Treating “one teach, one assist” as full co-teaching or mixing up parallel and station teaching.	How the class is split and who teaches what.
7	Person-first and strengths-based language	Describe the student first and the disability second, and write notes around strengths and needs rather than labels.	Using labels like “the autistic kid” or deficit-only descriptions in professional notes.	Choosing wording for notes, reports, or conversations with families.
8	Choosing a data measure	Use event recording for behaviors with a clear start and end that happen often, duration for how long a behavior lasts, and latency for time from a direction to the start of a response.	Counting how many times a behavior happens when the concern is how long it lasts.	The concern is phrased as “how often,” “how long,” or “how quickly.”

Course scope (public description): Early Clinical Experiences is a pivotal course designed to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical teaching skills. This course offers aspiring educators an immersive experience in real classroom settings under the mentorship of experienced teachers. Candidates engage in a range of activities, including observation, to develop a deeper understanding of classroom dynamics, student

engagement, and effective instructional strategies. Emphasizing reflective practice, the course encourages participants to analyze their experiences, integrate feedback, and adapt their teaching methods accordingly. This experiential learning approach equips future teachers with the confidence and competence necessary to foster a positive and impactful learning environment for their students.